Jainism and Buddhism- Similarities and Dissimilarities

Similarities	Dissimilarities	
	JAINISM	BUDDHISM
■ Both Mahavira and Buddha hailed from royal families. Yet they renounced royal privileges and chose to adopt an ascetic life. ■ Denied the authority of Vedas. ■ Taught in the language of the common people. ■ Admitted disciples from all the castes and from both the genders ■ Opposed blood sacrifices. ■ Believed in the doctrine of Karma. ■ Emphasized on right conduct and right knowledge instead of performing religious ceremonials and rituals as the means to achieve salvation.	■ It followed extreme path. ■ It remained in India only. ■ It does not believe in the existence of god, but believes life in every living being.	■ It followed middle path. ■ It spread across many parts of the world. ■ It emphasises on ANATMA (no eternal soul) and ANITYA (impernance).

Buddhist Councils

First	–	Rajagriha
Second	–	Vaishali
Third	–	Pataliputra
Fourth	–	Kashmir

Influence of Buddhism in Tamilnadu

- Buddhism spread to Tamil Nadu much later than Jainism.
- Manimekalai, one of the epics of the post-Sangam age is a Buddhist literature.
- There is an elaborate description about Kanchipuram in classical epic Manimegalai.
- Kanchipuram was a famous Buddhist Centre, from where Dinnaga, the famous Buddhist logician, and Dharmapala, a great scholar of Nalanda University hailed.
- Hieun Tsang who visited Kanchipuram in the seventh century A.D(CE). noticed the presence of 100 feet stupa built by Ashoka there.



Buddha statue at Nagapattinam



Buddha statue found at pallur near Kanchipuram

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